

Complete Blueprint for Service and Product Comparison Website

1. Project Overview

The website will be a comparison and lead-generation platform where customers can submit a requirement for a service or product, and relevant providers can respond with quotations. The customer can compare prices, service levels, reviews, availability, response time, location, and other key details before choosing a provider.

The long-term goal is to build a flexible platform that can support many categories and subcategories. At launch, the platform should focus on two main categories:

1. Builders and home improvement service providers
2. Freight forwarders and logistics service providers

The platform should work like a combination of MyBuilder, Upwork, Checktrade, Bark, and a quotation comparison website, but with a stronger focus on structured price comparison.

2. Main Purpose

The main purpose is to help users compare prices and service providers for any required service or product.

The platform should allow customers to:

- Post a job, requirement, shipment, project, or product request
- Select category and subcategory
- Add details, photos, files, deadlines, location, and budget if required
- Receive quotes from verified service providers
- Compare quotes side by side
- Check provider profile, reviews, previous jobs, and verification status
- Communicate with providers
- Accept, reject, or shortlist quotes
- Leave reviews after completion

The platform should allow service providers to:

- Register and create a professional profile
- Select categories and locations they cover
- Upload company documents, insurance, certificates, portfolio, and licences

- View matching customer requests
- Submit quotes
- Communicate with customers
- Manage leads, jobs, invoices, and ratings
- Upgrade to paid plans or buy leads if monetisation is added

3. Recommended Brand Positioning

The platform should be positioned as:

A smart comparison platform for services and products where customers can receive, compare, and choose quotes from verified providers.

Possible positioning lines:

- Compare trusted quotes in one place
- Post your requirement, compare prices, choose the best provider
- One platform to compare builders, freight forwarders, suppliers, and service providers
- Get multiple quotes, compare clearly, decide confidently

4. Core User Types

4.1 Customer

A customer is any person or business looking for a service, product, quote, or supplier.

Examples:

- Homeowner looking for a builder
- Business looking for a freight forwarder
- Company looking for packaging supplier
- Person looking for painter, plumber, joiner, or installer
- Importer looking for customs clearance and delivery quote

4.2 Service Provider

A service provider is a company, trader, freelancer, supplier, or business that can provide a quotation.

Examples:

- Builder
- Painter
- Plumber

- Electrician
- Joiner
- Kitchen fitter
- Freight forwarder
- Customs broker
- Courier company
- Warehouse provider
- Supplier or manufacturer

4.3 Admin

The admin team manages the platform.

Admin responsibilities:

- Approve or reject service providers
- Manage categories and subcategories
- Review disputes
- Monitor quotes and messages
- Manage payments and subscriptions
- Verify documents
- Manage fake reviews and spam
- Create featured listings
- Manage content pages
- View analytics and reports

4.4 Optional Future Role: Internal Sales Agent

The platform may later include internal sales agents who can help customers submit jobs, call providers, chase quotes, and close leads.

5. Launch Categories

5.1 Category 1: Builders and Home Improvement

Main category: Builders and Home Improvement

Suggested subcategories:

- General building work
- Extensions
- Loft conversions

- House renovation
- Kitchen fitting
- Bathroom fitting
- Joinery and carpentry
- Painting and decorating
- Plastering
- Roofing
- Plumbing
- Electrical work
- Flooring
- Windows and doors
- Landscaping
- Driveways
- Demolition
- Waste removal
- Air conditioning and heat pump installation
- Stairs and bespoke joinery

Builder Job Form Fields

Customer should be able to submit:

- Job title
- Category and subcategory
- Property type
- Job location/postcode
- Description of work
- Approximate budget, optional
- Desired start date
- Deadline, optional
- Planning permission status, if applicable
- Building control status, if applicable
- Materials supplied by customer or provider
- Upload images, drawings, videos, plans, PDFs
- Site visit required: yes/no
- Urgency level
- Preferred contact method

Builder Quote Fields

Provider should submit:

- Total price
- Labour cost
- Material cost
- VAT included or excluded
- Estimated start date
- Estimated completion time
- Whether site visit is required
- Payment schedule
- Warranty or guarantee
- Inclusions
- Exclusions
- Notes and assumptions
- Availability
- Quote expiry date

5.2 Category 2: Freight Forwarders and Logistics

Main category: Freight Forwarding and Logistics

Suggested subcategories:

- Air freight
- Sea freight
- Road freight
- Customs clearance
- Import service
- Export service
- Pallet delivery
- Container delivery
- Warehousing
- Fulfilment
- Amazon FBA delivery
- Tail lift delivery
- Heavy goods delivery
- Courier service
- Duty deferment service
- DDP/DDU shipping
- Pallet exchange service

Freight Request Form Fields

Customer should be able to submit:

- Shipment type
- Origin country/city/address
- Destination country/city/address
- Collection address
- Delivery address
- Incoterms, such as EXW, FOB, CIF, DAP, DDP
- Number of cartons, pallets, containers, or packages
- Dimensions
- Gross weight
- Volumetric weight, if known
- Commodity description
- HS code, optional
- Commercial invoice upload
- Packing list upload
- Need customs clearance: yes/no
- Need duty deferment: yes/no
- Need tail lift delivery: yes/no
- Pallet exchange required: yes/no
- Delivery booking required: yes/no
- Insurance required: yes/no
- Urgency
- Preferred delivery date
- Any special instructions

Freight Quote Fields

Provider should submit:

- Freight cost
- Customs clearance cost
- Delivery/haulage cost
- Documentation charges
- Warehouse or storage charges, if applicable
- Tail lift charge
- Pallet exchange included: yes/no
- VAT or duty handling notes
- Transit time
- Collection date
- Estimated delivery date

- Insurance cost, optional
- Validity of quote
- Inclusions
- Exclusions
- Notes and assumptions

6. Core Website Modules

6.1 Public Website

The public website should include:

- Homepage
- How it works
- Browse categories
- For customers page
- For providers page
- Pricing page
- Login/register
- Help centre
- About us
- Contact us
- Terms and conditions
- Privacy policy
- Cookie policy
- Trust and safety page

6.2 Customer Dashboard

Customer dashboard should include:

- Post new request
- Active requests
- Draft requests
- Received quotes
- Shortlisted quotes
- Accepted quotes
- Messages
- Uploaded files
- Reviews to leave

- Account settings
- Notifications

6.3 Provider Dashboard

Provider dashboard should include:

- Business profile
- Verification status
- Categories covered
- Service areas
- Matching leads
- Submitted quotes
- Won jobs
- Lost jobs
- Messages
- Reviews
- Subscription or lead credits
- Documents and certificates
- Account settings
- Notifications

6.4 Admin Dashboard

Admin dashboard should include:

- User management
- Provider approval
- Category management
- Request management
- Quote management
- Message monitoring, with privacy rules
- Review moderation
- Payment management
- Subscription management
- Lead credit management
- Dispute management
- CMS pages
- Reports and analytics
- Fraud and spam controls

7. Main Customer Workflow

Step 1: Customer visits website

Customer can search category or click “Get Quotes”.

Step 2: Customer selects category

Example:

- Builders and Home Improvement > Kitchen Fitting
- Freight Forwarding > Customs Clearance

Step 3: Customer completes structured form

The form should change depending on selected category.

Step 4: Customer creates account

Account can be created using:

- Email and password
- Google login
- Mobile verification, optional

Step 5: Request goes live

The request becomes visible to matching providers.

Step 6: Providers submit quotes

Providers can submit price, timeframe, terms, and notes.

Step 7: Customer compares quotes

Customer can compare quotes in a side-by-side table.

Comparison should show:

- Total price
- Provider name
- Rating
- Verification status
- Insurance status
- Availability
- Location

- Response time
- Quote validity
- Inclusions and exclusions
- Payment terms

Step 8: Customer shortlists providers

Customer can shortlist multiple providers.

Step 9: Customer communicates with providers

Messaging should be available after quote submission or lead purchase, depending on business model.

Step 10: Customer accepts quote

Customer can mark one quote as accepted.

Step 11: Job completed

Customer can leave review and rating.

8. Main Provider Workflow

Step 1: Provider registers

Provider enters:

- Business name
- Contact person
- Email
- Phone
- Company number, if applicable
- Address
- Website
- Categories
- Service areas

Step 2: Provider completes profile

Provider uploads:

- Logo
- Company description

- Portfolio images
- Insurance certificate
- Trade certificates
- Licence documents, if needed
- VAT number, optional
- Company registration documents, optional

Step 3: Admin verifies provider

Verification statuses:

- Not verified
- Email verified
- Phone verified
- Company verified
- Insurance verified
- Fully verified

Step 4: Provider views matching leads

Providers should see only leads that match their selected categories and locations.

Step 5: Provider submits quote

Provider completes structured quote form.

Step 6: Provider communicates with customer

Provider can clarify details and revise quote if required.

Step 7: Provider wins or loses job

Provider dashboard should show quote status.

9. Quote Comparison System

The quote comparison page is one of the most important parts of the platform.

It should allow customers to compare multiple quotes clearly.

Comparison Table Columns

- Provider name
- Verification badge
- Rating

- Number of reviews
- Total quote price
- VAT included/excluded
- Estimated start date
- Estimated completion date
- Labour cost
- Material cost
- Delivery/customs cost, for freight
- Warranty
- Payment terms
- Quote expiry
- Inclusions
- Exclusions
- Action buttons: message, shortlist, accept, reject

Sorting Options

Customer should be able to sort by:

- Lowest price
- Highest rating
- Fastest availability
- Nearest provider
- Most reviews
- Fully verified providers
- Fastest response time

Filtering Options

Customer should be able to filter by:

- Price range
- Rating
- Verified only
- Insurance verified
- Available this week
- Local providers
- VAT registered providers

10. Category and Subcategory System

The platform must be built with a flexible category system.

Each category should support:

- Parent category
- Subcategory
- Custom request form fields
- Custom quote form fields
- Provider eligibility rules
- Location requirement
- File upload requirement
- Pricing type
- Lead cost, if using lead credit model
- Visibility status

Example:

Parent category: Home Improvement

Subcategory: Kitchen Fitting

Custom fields: kitchen size, units supplied, worktop type, appliances, drawings upload

Parent category: Freight Forwarding

Subcategory: Customs Clearance

Custom fields: origin, destination, commodity, HS code, invoice upload, packing list upload

11. Dynamic Form Builder

Admin should be able to create and edit forms for each category without developer work.

Form field types:

- Text field
- Textarea
- Dropdown
- Multi-select
- Checkbox
- Radio button
- Date picker
- Time picker
- Number field
- Price field
- File upload
- Image upload
- Address field
- Postcode field

- Weight field
- Dimension field
- Yes/no field

Each field should support:

- Required or optional
- Help text
- Placeholder
- Validation rules
- Conditional logic
- Display order

Example conditional logic:

If customer selects “Need customs clearance: yes”, then show commercial invoice upload and HS code fields.

If customer selects “Site visit required: yes”, then show preferred visit date/time.

12. User Profiles

12.1 Customer Profile

Fields:

- Name
- Email
- Phone
- Address, optional
- Company name, optional
- Customer type: individual/business
- Saved requests
- Reviews given
- Notification preferences

12.2 Provider Profile

Fields:

- Business name
- Contact person
- Email

- Phone
- Website
- Business address
- Company number
- VAT number
- Years trading
- Team size
- Categories covered
- Locations covered
- About company
- Services offered
- Portfolio
- Documents
- Insurance details
- Certifications
- Reviews
- Average response time
- Jobs won
- Quote acceptance rate

13. Verification System

Verification builds trust and should be visible to customers.

Possible badges:

- Email verified
- Phone verified
- Company verified
- Insurance verified
- ID verified
- Address verified
- Licence verified
- Fully verified

Admin should be able to manually approve or reject documents.

Provider document statuses:

- Pending review
- Approved
- Rejected

- Expired

Providers should receive reminders before insurance or certificates expire.

14. Reviews and Ratings

Reviews should be allowed only after a quote is accepted or job is marked complete.

Review fields:

- Overall rating
- Price accuracy
- Communication
- Quality of work/service
- Timeliness
- Would recommend: yes/no
- Written review
- Photos, optional

Admin should be able to:

- Hide abusive reviews
- Mark reviews as verified
- Investigate disputed reviews
- Reply to provider complaints

15. Messaging System

Messaging should be built inside the platform.

Features:

- Customer/provider chat
- File sharing
- Quote revision requests
- Admin access for dispute review, subject to policy
- Email notifications
- Push notifications, future app
- Message templates
- Spam detection

Important rule:

Contact details may be hidden until a quote is submitted, lead is purchased, or customer accepts the provider. This depends on the final monetisation model.

16. Notifications

Notification channels:

- Email
- SMS, optional
- WhatsApp, future option
- In-app notification
- Push notification, future mobile app

Notification examples:

Customer:

- Your request is live
- You have received a new quote
- A provider has sent a message
- A quote has been revised
- Please leave a review

Provider:

- New matching request available
- Customer viewed your quote
- Customer shortlisted your quote
- Customer accepted your quote
- Customer sent a message
- Document verification approved/rejected

Admin:

- New provider awaiting approval
- New dispute opened
- Suspicious activity detected
- Reported review or message

17. Monetisation Options

The platform can use one or more monetisation models.

Option A: Lead Credit Model

Providers buy credits and spend credits to contact customers or submit quotes.

Example:

- Small lead: £5
- Medium lead: £10
- Large lead: £20+

Good for builders and trades.

Option B: Subscription Model

Providers pay monthly to access leads.

Example plans:

- Free: limited profile, limited quotes
- Basic: £29/month
- Pro: £79/month
- Premium: £149/month

Option C: Commission Model

Platform takes a percentage when a job is accepted and paid through the platform.

Good for product/service transactions but harder for offline building work.

Option D: Featured Listings

Providers pay to appear higher in search results or category pages.

Option E: Verification Fee

Providers pay a one-time or annual fee for enhanced verification.

Recommended MVP Monetisation

For the first version, use either:

1. Free provider registration plus manual sales outreach
2. Lead credit model
3. Monthly subscription for providers after beta testing

Do not make the customer pay at the start. The customer side should be free to attract requests.

18. MVP Scope

The MVP should be simple but complete enough to test the idea.

MVP Customer Features

- Register/login
- Post request
- Select category/subcategory
- Upload images/files
- Receive quotes
- Compare quotes
- Message providers
- Accept quote
- Leave review

MVP Provider Features

- Register/login
- Create business profile
- Select categories and service areas
- Upload documents
- View matching requests
- Submit quotes
- Message customers
- Track won/lost quotes

MVP Admin Features

- Login
- Manage users
- Manage providers
- Approve providers
- Manage categories
- View requests
- View quotes
- Manage reviews
- Basic reports

MVP Categories

- Builders and Home Improvement
- Freight Forwarding and Logistics

MVP Should Not Include Initially

- Mobile app
- Complex payment escrow
- AI matching
- Full accounting system
- Video calls
- Advanced dispute system
- Full marketplace commission payments

These can be added later.

19. Phase 2 Features

After MVP validation, add:

- Provider subscriptions
- Lead credits
- Stripe payments
- Automated verification checks
- Advanced quote comparison
- Saved searches
- Provider ranking algorithm
- Customer quote request templates
- AI quote summary
- AI category matching
- WhatsApp notifications
- CRM for admin sales team
- Blog and SEO category pages
- Mobile responsive app-like experience

20. Phase 3 Features

Long-term features:

- Mobile apps for iOS and Android
- Escrow payments
- Contract signing
- Invoice generation
- Provider calendar availability
- Real-time shipment tracking integration
- Trade-specific calculators
- API for logistics providers

- Supplier/product comparison
- Business account management
- Tender-style quote requests
- Multi-country expansion

21. Suggested Technology Stack

Frontend

Recommended:

- Next.js
- React
- Tailwind CSS
- TypeScript

Reason:

- Good for SEO
- Fast user experience
- Easy to build dashboards
- Strong developer ecosystem

Backend

Recommended options:

Option 1:

- Node.js with NestJS or Express
- PostgreSQL database

Option 2:

- Laravel
- MySQL or PostgreSQL

Option 3:

- Django
- PostgreSQL

Recommended for scalability:

- Next.js frontend
- Node.js/NestJS backend

- PostgreSQL database

Database

- PostgreSQL recommended

File Storage

- AWS S3 or similar

Authentication

- Email/password
- Google login optional
- Two-factor authentication for providers and admins

Payments

- Stripe

Email

- SendGrid, Postmark, Mailgun, or AWS SES

SMS

- Twilio or similar

Hosting

- AWS, DigitalOcean, Vercel, Render, or similar

Search

For MVP:

- PostgreSQL search

Later:

- Meilisearch, Algolia, or Elasticsearch

22. Suggested Database Tables

Core tables:

- users
- roles
- customers

- providers
- provider_profiles
- categories
- subcategories
- category_form_fields
- requests
- request_answers
- request_files
- quotes
- quote_items
- quote_files
- messages
- message_files
- reviews
- provider_documents
- verification_checks
- locations
- service_areas
- notifications
- subscriptions
- lead_credits
- payments
- admin_notes
- disputes
- audit_logs

23. Database Field Examples

users

- id
- name
- email
- phone
- password_hash
- role
- status
- email_verified_at
- phone_verified_at

- created_at
- updated_at

providers

- id
- user_id
- business_name
- company_number
- vat_number
- website
- business_address
- description
- years_trading
- team_size
- verification_status
- average_rating
- total_reviews
- created_at
- updated_at

categories

- id
- name
- slug
- description
- parent_id
- is_active
- display_order

requests

- id
- customer_id
- category_id
- subcategory_id
- title
- description
- location
- postcode
- status

- budget_min
- budget_max
- deadline
- urgency
- published_at
- created_at
- updated_at

quotes

- id
- request_id
- provider_id
- total_price
- currency
- vat_status
- start_date
- completion_time
- quote_valid_until
- inclusions
- exclusions
- payment_terms
- status
- created_at
- updated_at

messages

- id
- conversation_id
- sender_id
- receiver_id
- message
- read_at
- created_at

reviews

- id
- request_id
- provider_id
- customer_id

- rating
- communication_rating
- price_rating
- quality_rating
- time_rating
- review_text
- status
- created_at

24. Request Statuses

Customer request statuses:

- Draft
- Pending review
- Live
- Paused
- Closed
- Quote accepted
- Completed
- Cancelled
- Expired

Quote statuses:

- Submitted
- Viewed
- Shortlisted
- Revised
- Accepted
- Rejected
- Withdrawn
- Expired

Provider statuses:

- Pending approval
- Active
- Suspended
- Rejected
- Incomplete profile

25. Matching Logic

A provider should see a request if:

- Provider is active
- Provider covers the selected category/subcategory
- Provider covers the customer location or shipment route
- Provider account is approved, depending on rules
- Provider has enough lead credits, if monetisation is active

For builders:

- Match by postcode radius
- Match by trade category
- Match by availability, optional later

For freight forwarders:

- Match by origin and destination country
- Match by service type
- Match by shipment mode
- Match by customs capability

26. Provider Ranking Logic

Provider ranking should consider:

- Verification level
- Average rating
- Number of reviews
- Response speed
- Quote acceptance rate
- Profile completeness
- Distance from job
- Subscription plan, if featured listings are used
- Admin quality score

Important: Paid listings should be labelled clearly if they affect ranking.

27. SEO Strategy

SEO is very important for long-term traffic.

The platform should have SEO pages for:

- Each main category
- Each subcategory
- Each city/location
- Category + location combinations

Examples:

- Compare builders in Preston
- Get freight forwarding quotes in Manchester
- Customs clearance agents in the UK
- Kitchen fitters near me
- Air freight quotes from China to UK

Each SEO page should include:

- Title
- Meta description
- Short guide
- FAQs
- Related categories
- Call to action
- Trust badges
- Provider examples, if available

28. Admin Category Management

Admin should be able to:

- Add category
- Add subcategory
- Edit category description
- Create custom request form
- Create custom quote form
- Set lead price
- Activate/deactivate category
- Set SEO title and meta description
- Add category image/icon
- Set provider requirements

29. Security Requirements

Security features:

- Password hashing
- HTTPS only
- Secure file uploads
- Malware scanning for uploaded files, if possible
- Rate limiting
- Spam protection
- reCAPTCHA or similar
- Email verification
- Admin activity logs
- Role-based permissions
- Data encryption where required
- GDPR compliance

30. GDPR and Legal Requirements

The website should include:

- Privacy policy
- Cookie policy
- Terms and conditions
- Provider terms
- Customer terms
- Review policy
- Dispute policy
- Data deletion request process
- Marketing consent checkbox
- Cookie consent banner

Customer and provider data must be handled according to UK GDPR.

31. Dispute Handling

A simple MVP dispute system should allow users to report:

- Fake quote
- No response
- Bad behaviour
- Incorrect service information
- Payment issue
- Review dispute
- Provider fraud

Admin should be able to:

- Open dispute case
- Add internal notes
- Request evidence
- Suspend user/provider
- Hide review
- Mark case resolved

32. Analytics and Reporting

Admin should be able to see:

- Number of registered customers
- Number of registered providers
- Number of new requests
- Number of quotes submitted
- Average quotes per request
- Quote acceptance rate
- Most popular categories
- Most active locations
- Provider response time
- Revenue from subscriptions or lead credits
- Conversion rate from request to accepted quote

33. Suggested User Interface Pages

Public Pages

- Homepage
- Category listing page
- Category detail page
- Subcategory detail page
- Location SEO page
- Provider signup page
- Customer signup page
- Login page
- Help centre
- Contact page

Customer Pages

- Customer dashboard
- Post request
- Request detail
- Quote comparison page
- Message inbox
- Provider profile view
- Review page
- Account settings

Provider Pages

- Provider dashboard
- Profile setup
- Matching leads
- Lead detail
- Submit quote
- Quote management
- Message inbox
- Reviews
- Subscription/credits
- Document verification
- Account settings

Admin Pages

- Admin dashboard
- Users
- Providers
- Requests
- Quotes
- Categories
- Form builder
- Reviews
- Documents
- Payments
- Disputes
- Reports
- CMS pages
- Settings

34. Homepage Structure

Suggested homepage sections:

1. Hero section
 - Headline: Compare quotes from trusted service providers
 - Subheading: Post your requirement and receive multiple quotes from verified providers
 - Search/category selector
 - Call to action: Get Quotes
2. How it works
 - Post your request
 - Receive quotes
 - Compare and choose
3. Popular categories
 - Builders
 - Freight forwarding
 - Kitchen fitting
 - Customs clearance
 - Painting
 - Pallet delivery
4. Why use the platform
 - Save time
 - Compare prices
 - Verified providers
 - Clear quote breakdowns
 - Reviews and ratings
5. Provider call to action
 - Are you a service provider? Join and receive leads
6. Trust section
 - Verified profiles
 - Secure messaging
 - Review system
7. FAQ
8. Footer

35. Quote Comparison Page Layout

The quote comparison page should include:

- Request summary at top

- Quote cards
- Side-by-side comparison table
- Sort and filter controls
- Shortlist button
- Message button
- Accept quote button
- Request quote revision button
- Provider profile preview

Each quote card should show:

- Provider logo/name
- Rating
- Verification badge
- Total price
- Start date
- Completion time
- Key inclusions
- Key exclusions
- View full quote button

36. Provider Profile Page Layout

Provider profile should show:

- Business name
- Logo
- Verification badges
- Rating
- Number of reviews
- About business
- Services offered
- Locations covered
- Portfolio images
- Insurance/certification badges
- Recent reviews
- Response time
- Request quote button

37. Important MVP Rules

To keep the MVP manageable:

- Do not allow unlimited categories at launch without admin control
- Do not build complex payments first unless required
- Do not allow providers to see customer contact details before quote rules are satisfied
- Do not allow customers to leave reviews unless the job was accepted through the platform
- Keep quote forms structured so comparison is easy
- Make admin approval simple but strict
- Build mobile responsive from day one

38. Development Milestones

Milestone 1: Planning and Design

- Finalise requirements
- Finalise user roles
- Finalise category structure
- Create wireframes
- Create UI design
- Finalise database schema

Milestone 2: Core Development

- Authentication
- User roles
- Customer dashboard
- Provider dashboard
- Admin dashboard
- Category management
- Request posting
- Quote submission

Milestone 3: Communication and Comparison

- Messaging
- Quote comparison table
- Shortlist/accept/reject quote
- Notifications
- File uploads

Milestone 4: Trust and Verification

- Provider profile
- Document upload
- Admin verification
- Reviews and ratings
- Reporting tools

Milestone 5: Testing and Launch

- QA testing
- Security testing
- Mobile testing
- User acceptance testing
- Beta launch
- Feedback collection
- Bug fixing

Milestone 6: Monetisation

- Stripe integration
- Subscription plans
- Lead credit system
- Featured listings
- Provider billing dashboard

39. MVP Acceptance Criteria

The MVP is ready when:

- Customer can register and post a request
- Provider can register and complete profile
- Admin can approve provider
- Provider can view matching requests
- Provider can submit quote
- Customer can compare quotes
- Customer can message provider
- Customer can accept quote
- Customer can leave review
- Admin can manage categories, users, requests, quotes, and reviews
- Website is mobile responsive
- Basic notifications work
- Uploaded files are secure and accessible only to authorised users

40. Suggested Future AI Features

AI can later be added to improve the platform.

Possible AI features:

- Suggest correct category from customer description
- Summarise long quotes
- Highlight cheapest quote, best-rated quote, and fastest quote
- Detect missing quote details
- Detect suspicious provider behaviour
- Generate request descriptions from photos and notes
- Help providers create professional quotes
- Estimate price range based on previous requests

41. Key Risks and Solutions

Risk 1: Customers post low-quality requests

Solution:

- Use structured forms
- Make important fields mandatory
- Add upload prompts
- Use AI or admin review later

Risk 2: Providers submit unclear quotes

Solution:

- Use structured quote forms
- Require total price, inclusions, exclusions, and validity
- Allow customer to request revision

Risk 3: Fake providers

Solution:

- Verification system
- Admin approval
- Document checks
- Review monitoring

Risk 4: Users move outside the platform

Solution:

- Hide contact details until rules are met
- Provide built-in messaging
- Offer value through quote comparison and reviews

Risk 5: Too many categories too early

Solution:

- Start with two categories
- Build category system flexible for future
- Add categories after testing

42. Recommended First Version Build

For the first build, developers should create:

1. Public website
2. Customer registration/login
3. Provider registration/login
4. Admin login
5. Category and subcategory management
6. Dynamic request form system
7. Dynamic quote form system
8. Customer request posting
9. Provider matching
10. Quote submission
11. Quote comparison page
12. Messaging
13. Provider profile
14. Reviews
15. Verification document upload
16. Admin dashboard
17. Email notifications
18. Mobile responsive design

43. Example Customer Journey: Builder

1. Customer clicks “Get quotes for building work”
2. Selects “Kitchen fitting”
3. Enters postcode

4. Adds description and photos
5. Selects desired start date
6. Submits request
7. Three kitchen fitters submit quotes
8. Customer compares price, start date, reviews, and inclusions
9. Customer messages two providers
10. Customer accepts one quote
11. Job is completed
12. Customer leaves review

44. Example Customer Journey: Freight Forwarder

1. Customer clicks “Compare freight quotes”
2. Selects “Sea freight from China to UK”
3. Enters origin, destination, cartons, pallets, weight, and dimensions
4. Uploads invoice and packing list
5. Selects customs clearance and tail lift delivery
6. Freight providers submit quotes
7. Customer compares freight cost, clearance cost, delivery cost, and transit time
8. Customer accepts one quote
9. Provider handles shipment
10. Customer leaves review

45. Final Recommendation

The platform should be built as a flexible comparison marketplace, not just a builders directory. The most important foundation is the category and dynamic form system. If this is designed properly from the start, the platform can later compare almost anything, including builders, freight forwarders, suppliers, products, professional services, and local trades.

The first MVP should focus on getting real customer requests and real provider quotes, even if some admin tasks are manual at the beginning. Once the platform proves demand, monetisation through lead credits, provider subscriptions, and featured listings can be added.